

# **The United Associations of Vietnamese Students in NSW**

## **COMPETITION RULES UAVS HACKATHON 2026**

### **I. PURPOSE - OBJECTIVES**

UAVS Hackathon 2026 is a hands-on technology competition organised by **The United Associations of Vietnamese Students in NSW**, focusing on the application of **artificial intelligence (AI) and Machine Learning** to solve real-world problems for businesses and non-profit organisations in Australia. The competition is a platform connecting the Vietnamese student community in Australia with partner businesses and organisations, responding to the nation's spirit of breakthrough development in science, technology, innovation and digital transformation.

### **II. ELIGIBILITY**

- Vietnamese undergraduate and master's students (holding Vietnamese citizenship) currently studying and working in Australia.
- International students studying in Australia may participate provided that at least 02 out of 05 team members are Vietnamese.
- No restriction on major. Students majoring in Information Technology, Computer Science, Software Engineering, Data Science, Electrical-Electronic Engineering and related fields are especially encouraged.

### **III. REGISTRATION**

#### **1. Registration method**

- The competition only accepts team registrations. Individual registrations are not accepted.
- Register via the official online form (link to be published on 08/08/2026).

#### **2. Team size and eligibility conditions**

- Each team must have a minimum of 03 and a maximum of 05 members.
- At least 02 of the members must hold Vietnamese citizenship.
- A member may not participate in 02 or more teams at the same time.
- Changes to team members after the registration deadline (05/09/2026) will not be accepted.
- The Organising Committee welcomes multidisciplinary/multi-university teams, as this is an advantage in solving cross-disciplinary problems.

#### **3. Registration deadline**

- From 08/08/2026 until 23:59 on 05/09/2026 (AEST). Applications submitted after the deadline will not be considered.

### **IV. CONTENT AND RULES OF EACH ROUND**

The competition consists of 03 main rounds plus a Talkshow event:

- **Talkshow (22/08/2026):** Online via Zoom
- **Round 1: Idea Registration (08/08 - 05/09/2026):** Teams submit member registration and an idea proposal based on their chosen problem statement.
- **Round 2: 16-Hour Hackathon (12/09 - 13/09/2026):** A focused 16-hour solution-building round, split into 02 days of 08 hours each.
- **Round 3: Gala Pitching Night (20/09/2026):** Pitching, Q&A and awards round

## **A. Talkshow**

### **1. General information**

- **Time:** 22/08/2026 (exact time to be announced later)
- **Format:** Online via Zoom
- **Attendance:** Encouraged but not mandatory

### **2. Content**

- Representatives of the 03 official partner businesses/non-profit organisations introduce their organisation and present their problem statement in detail.
- Contestants ask questions directly to the businesses to clarify requirements before submitting their proposal.
- An opportunity for networking between contestants, businesses and the Organising Committee.

### **3. Note**

- This is the only opportunity for teams to ask businesses questions directly before submitting their proposal. The Organising Committee therefore encourages all teams to attend.
- The Organising Committee will publish a summary of the meeting notes within 24 hours after the event, sent to all registered teams (including teams that did not attend).
- Round 1 Problem Statement will be officially released from 08/08/2026 on UAVS-NSW's media channels.

## **B. Round 1 - Idea Registration**

### **1. General information**

- Opens: 08/08/2026
- Submission deadline: 23:59 on 05/09/2026 (AEST)
- Results announced: 08/09/2026
- Format: Online - submitted via the Organising Committee's online form

### **2. Task**

Each team selects **01 of the 03 open problem statements** set by the partner businesses/non-profit organisations and prepares an Idea Proposal that clearly demonstrates their approach and how they will address the problem using AI/Machine Learning solutions.

### **3. Output requirements**

An idea description document (.pdf format, **maximum 07 pages**, 11–12pt font, minimum 2cm margins) containing the following content:

- + **Product/project name**

- + **Team information:** members' full names, university, contact email, team leader's phone number
- + **Chosen problem statement and reason for the choice**
- + **Problem framing:** the specific pain point and target user your team has identified within the challenge question, and the research (public reports, the organisation's channels, comparable products) that led you there
- + **Assumptions & open questions:** what you're assuming about the organisation and its users, and the questions you'd put to the Problem Setter if you could
- + **Proposed solution:** AI/ML approach and how the problem will be solved
- + **Overview design:** system architecture diagram or wireframe
- + **Preliminary implementation direction (roadmap)**
- + **Sources** (exclude from the 7-page limit)

#### 4. Evaluation criteria

| Criteria group                          | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Score |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|
| 1. Problem framing & depth of research  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Defines a specific problem inside the challenge question rather than restating it.</li> <li>- Clearly explains why AI/ML is the appropriate choice</li> <li>- Demonstrates independent research into the organisation, its sector and its constraints, with sources</li> <li>- States assumptions explicitly and flags what it would verify with the Problem Setter</li> <li>- The proposed solution is well-founded, logical and closely follows the organisation's interest</li> </ul> | 30    |
| 2. Feasibility                          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Legitimate and reliable data sources</li> <li>- Feasible technical approach for building &amp; shipping the product</li> <li>- Estimated infrastructure and operating costs</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 25    |
| 3. Creativity & innovation              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- A novel approach compared with existing solutions</li> <li>- Creative application of AI/ML, not merely a mechanical use of existing tools</li> <li>- Degree of originality in the solution design and user experience</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | 15    |
| 4. Practical impact                     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- The solution effectively solves the real problem set by the organisation</li> <li>- Estimated concrete value/benefits delivered (time savings, cost savings, increased efficiency, etc.)</li> <li>- Feasibility of deployment under real-world conditions</li> <li>- Development roadmap (preliminary)</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                        | 20    |
| 5. Documentation & presentation quality | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Proposal is logically presented and polished, in the required format</li> <li>- Clear language, free of spelling errors</li> <li>- Illustrative architecture diagram (wireframe)</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | 10    |

Round 1 is scored on how you approach an open problem. The full brief and constraints are provided to advancing teams at the start of Round 2. The Judging Panel will select up to **20 teams** with the highest total scores to advance to Round 2. Round 1 scores do not carry over to subsequent rounds.

### **5. Notes and disqualification conditions**

- Each team may submit only 01 proposal for 01 case study. If submitted multiple times, only the last submission before the deadline will be counted.
- Entries must be written in English.
- An entry will be immediately disqualified if:
  - + It is submitted after the specified deadline or in the wrong format
  - + It exceeds the 07-page limit
  - + It copies content from another team
  - + It is missing team information or other required information

## **C. Round 2 - 16-Hour Hackathon**

### **1. General information**

- Day 1: 12/09/2026 - 09:00 to 17:00 AEST (8 hours) - Build
- Day 2: 13/09/2026 - 09:00 to 17:00 AEST (8 hours) - Finalise
- Submission deadline: 17:00 on 13/09/2026 (AEST). Late submissions will absolutely not be accepted.
- Teams advancing to the Gala announced: 16/09/2026 or 17/09/2026
- Format: In-person in Sydney, NSW (exact venue to be announced later)

### **2. Task**

The maximum of 20 best teams from Round 1 take part in the 16-Hour Hackathon, turning their idea into a working product:

- Day 1 (first 08 hours): Build the MVP - a minimum viable AI product that runs and solves the core problem of the chosen case study.
- Day 2 (next 08 hours): Refine the prototype, test it, improve UX/UI, complete the technical documentation and prepare the pitch deck for Round 3.

### **3. Output requirements**

Submit the complete product via the Organising Committee's official channel before 17:00 on 13/09/2026:

- **Product/AI solution demo:** A prototype or MVP that runs and can be demonstrated live.
- **Technical Documentation (README.MD):** A description of the system architecture, list of technologies/APIs used, and installation/running instructions.
- **GitHub/repository link:** Containing the full source code (public, or with access shared with the Organising Committee).
- **Pitch Deck:** To be used for Round 3 - Gala Pitching Night.

### **4. Evaluation criteria**

| Criteria group                   | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Score |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|
| 1. User experience               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Clearly identifies and understands the target users</li> <li>- Correctly meets the main needs of the target users</li> <li>- Intuitive, easy-to-use interface, optimised for user interaction</li> <li>- Ensures consistency in experience and design</li> </ul>                                                                      | 20    |
| 2. Technical quality             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- A working product (functional demo/prototype/MVP)</li> <li>- Repository + one-command setup instructions</li> <li>- Clear system architecture, clean code, reproducible</li> <li>- Effective AI/ML integration, technically sound and appropriate for the problem</li> <li>- Ensures information security and data privacy</li> </ul> | 25    |
| 3. Deployability and scalability | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Feasibility of real-world deployment (resources, infrastructure, operating costs)</li> <li>- Plan for scaling as the number of users/amount of data grows</li> <li>- Ensures legal compliance and data safety under current regulations</li> </ul>                                                                                    | 20    |
| 4. Market strategy               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Identifies the customer segment/beneficiaries and the value model delivered</li> <li>- Analyses competitive advantage compared with existing solutions on the market</li> <li>- Proposes distribution channels, partnerships or a go-to-market roadmap</li> </ul>                                                                     | 25    |
| 5. Adaptation & upgrade          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- How well the team incorporated the full case study and Problem Setter input</li> <li>- Adds useful supplementary features that increase the product's value</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                | 10    |

The Judging Panel will select up to 10 of the best teams to advance to Round 3 - Gala Pitching Night. Round 2 scores do not carry over to Round 3.

## 5. Venue regulations

### a) *Equipment and resources:*

- Each member must bring their own personal laptop. The Organising Committee does not provide hardware equipment.
- The Organising Committee provides: high-speed Wifi, sufficient power outlets, tables and chairs, drinking water and catering (snacks + lunch each day).
- Teams may use any programming language, framework, open-source library or public API.

### b) *Code and product regulations:*

- All code must be written during the Hackathon period (Day 1 & Day 2). Using code written before 09:00 on 12/09/2026 is strictly prohibited.
- Permitted: open-source libraries, public APIs (OpenAI, Google Gemini, Anthropic, etc.), pre-trained models, common boilerplate code.

- AI coding assistant tools (GitHub Copilot, Cursor, etc.) are permitted, but AI must not be used to generate the entire product without the team's oversight and understanding.
  - All external resources (datasets, APIs, libraries) must be clearly declared in the Technical Documentation.
- c) *Advisor regulations:*
- Advisors may only provide guidance and consultation; Advisors are strictly prohibited from writing code or building the product on behalf of the team.
  - Technical questions for Advisors must go through the Organising Committee's official channel to ensure fairness among teams.
  - Representatives of the businesses that set the case studies may visit the venue to answer questions in person.
- d) *Code of conduct at the venue:*
- All members must be fully present at the venue according to the schedule. Participating online is not permitted as a substitute for an absent member.
  - Teams may not share code, ideas or solutions with other teams during the competition.
  - Keep the venue clean and orderly. Do not make noise that disturbs other teams.
  - The Organising Committee will not accept any further changes to product content after 17:00 on 13/09/2026.

## D. Round 3 - Gala Pitching Night

### 1. General information

- Time: 20/09/2026 (exact time to be announced later)
- Format: In-person in Sydney, NSW (exact venue to be announced later)

### 2. Content

Teams that advance to the Gala Pitching Night present and demonstrate their product live before the Judging Panel, delegates and audience. The maximum duration is **10 minutes/team** for the pitch, followed by a **05-minute Q&A** with the Judging Panel. After all teams have finished, the Judging Panel will deliberate and announce the results.

### 3. Requirements

- All team members must be fully present at the Gala Pitching Night.
- The Finalised Pitch Deck must be submitted to the Organising Committee before 23:59 on 19/09/2026.
- The product demo must be the version submitted in Round 2. Updating or changing core features after the Round 2 deadline is strictly prohibited.
- Teams must bring their own computer for the demo. The Organising Committee provides a projector screen and internet connection.

### 4. Evaluation criteria

| Criteria group   | Description                                                                                                                                                                         | Score |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|
| 1. Pitch quality | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Clear presentation content, well-structured, logical and persuasive</li> <li>- Concisely conveys the core value of the solution</li> </ul> | 30    |

|                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |    |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
|                                  | - Complies with the time requirement (maximum 10 minutes)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |    |
| 2. Live product demo             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- The product runs stably with no errors during the live demo</li> <li>- Intuitive, easy-to-understand demo that clearly shows the core AI/ML features</li> <li>- Intuitive and engaging user experience (UX)</li> </ul>                                                   | 25 |
| 3. Q&A responses - defence       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Deep understanding of the solution, mastering both the technical and business aspects</li> <li>- Handles challenging questions from the Judging Panel thoroughly and convincingly</li> <li>- Sharp analytical thinking, direct and well-substantiated answers</li> </ul> | 25 |
| 4. Deployment potential & impact | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Real-world feasibility: resources, infrastructure, legal aspects</li> <li>- Specific and well-founded implementation roadmap</li> <li>- Value delivered to the partner organisation and the community</li> </ul>                                                         | 20 |

**Note:** The Gala Pitching Night score is the final ranking score (1st/2nd/3rd place). The Judging Panel may add supplementary criteria from the case-study business to ensure accuracy. The Judging Panel's decision is final and cannot be appealed.

## V. TEAM COMPOSITION & WITHDRAWAL POLICY

### 1. Intellectual property

Once a team's registration has been submitted, no changes to team membership will be accepted under any circumstances. This includes adding new members, replacing existing members, or transferring a member to another team.

### 2. Withdrawal of a team member

If a team member needs to permanently withdraw from the competition, the remaining team members must notify the Organising Committee as soon as possible via official email at [antv.event.uavnsnw@gmail.com](mailto:antv.event.uavnsnw@gmail.com) with the subject line: "[MEMBER WITHDRAWAL] [Team Name] - [Member Name] - Round [1/2/3]"

The email must include:

- Team name
- Full name and role of the withdrawing member
- Names and roles of all remaining members
- Total number of remaining members after withdrawal
- Round in which the withdrawal is taking place
- Reason for withdrawal
- Any additional note

Upon receiving a valid request, the Organising Committee will review the case individually and communicate its decision within 48 hours. Possible outcomes include:

- The team is permitted to continue competing with the remaining members

- The team is required to withdraw from the competition if the remaining members no longer meet the minimum eligibility requirements (e.g. fewer than 02 members, or fewer than 02 Vietnamese citizens)

### **3. Non-compliance**

Teams that fail to notify the Organising Committee of a member's withdrawal, or whose request does not meet the above requirements, will have their continued participation in the current and future UAVS events reviewed at the Organising Committee's discretion.

Withdrawal requests submitted via social media, WhatsApp, or any channel other than the official email will not be processed or considered valid.

## **VI. LATE ARRIVAL POLICY**

### **1. General requirements**

All team members are required to be present at the venue by 09:00 on each day of the Hackathon.

### **2. Standard rules**

- Members arriving after 10:00 will not be permitted to enter the venue for that day
- If a team has no members present by 10:00 on either day, the team will be immediately disqualified
- If a team has fewer than 03 members present by 10:00, the team will be disqualified

### **3. Emergency Late Arrival**

Teams must notify the Organising Committee immediately upon knowing they will be late by sending a WhatsApp message to **+61 435 841 870**.

Conditions:

- The Organising Committee will review the case and notify venue staff if the request is approved
- Only genuine emergencies supported by valid evidence will be considered. Accepted forms of evidence include photographic documentation of the emergency or a medical certificate
- Approved late arrivals will be permitted entry up to a maximum of 3 hours after the start time (12:00 AEST). No exceptions will be made after this cutoff regardless of circumstance
- Venue staff will follow standard rules by default. Exceptions will only be made if the Organising Committee has notified staff in advance

### **4. Member Illness During the Hackathon**

- Members who become unwell during the Hackathon may use the dedicated rest area provided at the venue
- Members may return to their team and resume participation upon recovery within the same day
- Members who were present on Day 1 but became unwell are permitted to participate on Day 2

### **5. Whole Team Arriving Late**

- Teams arriving before 10:00 will be permitted to enter as normal

- Teams arriving after 10:00 will not be permitted to enter and will be disqualified from the competition

## **VII. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY & DATA SHARING POLICY**

### **1. Ownership**

Intellectual property of all submissions remains with the respective teams. The Organising Committee and Problem Setter organisations do not claim ownership over any submitted work.

### **2. What Problem Setters Receive**

Upon conclusion of the competition, the Organising Committee will share the following materials with the relevant Problem Setter organisation which is limited strictly to the Problem Setter whose challenge the team selected:

- Pitch deck submitted for Round 3
- Technical documentation (system architecture, technology stack, and approach overview)
- Demo link or demo video
- Talent Innovation Report, including team name, member names, LinkedIn profiles, and a brief summary of the team's approach

Source code will not be shared with Problem Setter organisations. If a team wishes to share their source code with a Problem Setter, they may do so independently at their own discretion following the conclusion of the competition.

### **3. Problem Setter Rights & Restrictions**

Problem Setter organisations are granted a non-exclusive, non-transferable right to view and evaluate submitted materials for internal talent assessment and solution review purposes. Problem Setter organisations may not:

- Reproduce, commercialise, or distribute any team's submission without explicit written consent from the team
- Share submitted materials with any third party outside their organisation
- Use submitted materials for any purpose beyond internal evaluation

### **4. Direct Introduction**

Following the conclusion of the competition, UAVS-NSW may facilitate direct introductions between Problem Setter organisations and standout participants based on registered information including name and LinkedIn profile. This is conducted at UAVS-NSW's discretion as part of the talent pipeline benefit offered to Problem Setter partners.

### **5. Consent**

Participation in UAVS Hackathon 2026 constitutes full agreement to the terms outlined in this policy. By completing registration, all team members acknowledge and consent to the sharing of their submission and profile information with the relevant Problem Setter organisation as described above. This is a non-negotiable condition of participation

## **VIII. GENERAL REGULATIONS**

## **1. Intellectual property**

Teams bear full responsibility for the intellectual property of their product and the accuracy of the information provided to the Organising Committee. Competition entries must not be subject to any copyright dispute. The use of open-source libraries or third-party resources must comply with the corresponding licence.

## **2. Right to use information**

The Organising Committee has the right to use information about teams, project names and products for communication and reporting purposes. The Organising Committee has the right to take photographs, film and record audio throughout the event. Teams are deemed to agree to this term upon completing registration.

## **3. Confidentiality of case-study information**

Information, data and documents from partner businesses/organisations may only be used for competition purposes within the scope of UAVS Hackathon 2026. Teams must not share case-study information or partner data outside the scope of the competition in any form.

## **4. Code of conduct**

All contestants, advisors and Organising Committee members must maintain a respectful and professional competition environment. Harassment, discrimination, deliberate disruption or obstruction of other teams will result in immediate disqualification from the competition.

## **5. Disqualification conditions**

A team will be immediately disqualified if it falls into any of the following cases:

- Copying or duplicating content from another team, or being unable to prove the authenticity of the product.
- Failing to meet the minimum output requirements of each round.
- A member is ineligible to participate or has provided false information during registration.
- Using code written before the start of the Hackathon (09:00 on 12/09/2026).
- Having an Advisor write code or build the product on the team's behalf.
- Violating the code of conduct or any regulation in these Rules.

## **6. Handling unforeseen situations**

During the event, if issues arise that are not covered by these Rules, the Organising Committee will consider amendments or additions as appropriate and notify teams via official channels. All changes take effect immediately upon official announcement.

## **7. Official information channels**

All announcements are posted on UAVS-NSW's social media channels and sent by email to the registered team leader. The Organising Committee is not responsible if a team fails to receive a notification due to inaccurate registration information.

## **8. Contact information**

Organising Committee email: **[antv.event.uavsns@gmail.com](mailto:antv.event.uavsns@gmail.com)**

Please send any questions about the competition to the above email. The Organising Committee will respond within 48 working hours.